Missed calls by trade (UK) — open dataset

Published by Ringzel. A small, fully cited collection of public statistics on missed business phone calls in the UK, Per-trade figures are a documented gap. File: `missed-calls-by-trade-uk.csv` (10 rows). See `DATA-DICTIONARY.md`.

Headline findings

- UK small businesses lose an estimated **£3.67bn a year (indicative)** to missed calls, and **67%** miss at least one call a day that they believe costs them business (BT Business / Censuswide, Sept 2026, 1,500 SMEs). BT
- **75%** of UK consumers give a business three call attempts before giving up; **58%** would tell friends and family to avoid a business that didn't pick up (BT / Censuswide, 2,000 adults). BT
- **34%** of tradespeople believe they've lost work by not answering the phone and **60%** struggle to answer while working (Fix Radio, 2022, 220+ tradespeople). Fix Radio

Gaps: no per-trade missed-call rates

We couldn't find any independent, verifiable source for missed-call rates or losses by individual trade (e.g. plumbers, salons, clinics, estate agents, garages, law firms, accountants or vets). Ofcom, ONS and the FSB don't publish them. This dataset therefore makes no claims about specific trades beyond the Fix Radio survey of construction tradespeople. Contributions of public, citable per-trade figures are welcome.

Methodology

We searched for public UK missed-call statistics from regulators, government, trade bodies and surveys. Every figure was checked on its source page on 23 October 2026 and copied as published. We dropped any number we couldn't find on a live page, plus US-only data and statistics published by companies that sell call-answering services in competition with Ringzel. The dataset contains no Ringzel customer or demo-call data.

Limitations

- The BT figures come from research commissioned by BT Business, which sells an AI receptionist. The £3.67bn is modelled from respondents' own estimates, and BT describes it as indicative.
- Fix Radio's survey is a media poll that doesn't publish its method in detail.
- The two sources use different samples and years, so don't compare their rows directly.
- Ringzel, which publishes this dataset, works in the call-answering market.

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CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). Credit: "Ringzel (RINGZEL LTD, company no. 17507564), Missed calls by trade (UK), 2026". The underlying statistics belong to the sources cited; please cite them too.

About Ringzel

Ringzel (https://ringzel.com) is an AI receptionist for businesses of any type. You keep your own number and divert calls to Ringzel when you can't answer. RINGZEL LTD, company no. 17507564, 71-75 Shelton Street, Covent Garden, London WC2H 9JQ. Tel +44 7457 410396.

Related guides:

- AI receptionist cost guide (UK): https://ringzel.com/en-gb/blog/ai-receptionist-cost-uk/
- What a missed call costs a UK trade: https://ringzel.com/en-gb/blog/missed-call-cost-uk-trade/
- Industry pages: https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/ — plumbers https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/plumbers/, electricians https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/electricians/, salons https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/salons/, clinics https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/clinics/, dentists https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/dentists/, estate agents https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/estate-

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